

Social Impact Assessment Report

Bhavani River Bridge & Approach Road, Sirumugai · RFCTLARR ss.4-6 · SIA Unit, Coimbatore

1. Scope and method

The assessment was carried out under s.4 of the Act following the notification of intent. It covers a house-to-house census of every household in the corridor and a 300 m band either side, group consultations in each of the three affected revenue villages, and a public hearing convened under s.5.

The census was conducted between the dates recorded in the project file and enumerated 77 affected families.

2. Affected and displaced families

77 families are affected within the meaning of s.3(c). Of these, 60 are titleholders identified from the record of rights, and 17 are non-titleholders who could only be identified by the census: tenant cultivators, agricultural labourers dependent on the acquired holdings, and residents of more than three years standing without title.

12 families are displaced — that is, they lose the dwelling they occupy, not merely land they cultivate. The distinction matters: displaced families are entitled under the Second Schedule to housing, a resettlement site, transportation and a subsistence allowance which land-losing families who are not displaced do not receive.

The disproportionate presence of non-titleholders on nanjai land reflects the labour intensity of double-cropped paddy, and is the reason a titleholder count alone would have understated the R&R obligation by roughly a quarter.

3. Impact on livelihoods and common property

16.0445 hectares pass out of cultivation, of which the nanjai component is under two paddy crops a year. Households dependent on that land as tenants or labourers lose the whole of that income rather than a share of an asset, which is why their entitlement is assessed on dependency and not on extent.

Common property affected: one village threshing floor in Alangombu, a section of field channel serving four holdings on the south bank, and eleven roadside tamarind trees held in common. Each is to be reprovided rather than compensated in cash.

4. Public hearing and objections

The public hearing was held in each affected village. The principal objections recorded were: the adequacy of the guideline value as a measure of market value for irrigated land; the position of the southern approach relative to an existing field channel; and the timing of possession relative to the standing crop.

The first is addressed by the multiplier applied under s.26 read with the First Schedule. The second resulted in a 40 m eastward shift of the southern approach at chainage 1+180. The third is addressed by scheduling possession after the samba harvest.

5. Conclusion

The extent of land proposed is the minimum required for the stated public purpose, no unaffected alternative exists that would take less, and the potential benefits outweigh the social costs, subject to the R&R entitlements in the Second Schedule being delivered in full and in advance of possession.